Blueprint Section & Navigation Plan

1. 1. Objectives & Success Criteria

- **Primary goal**: Give a "blank user" a clear, intriguing, 30,000-foot understanding of AreTéCracy as a *buildable system*, and invite them into deeper exploration.
- **Target audiences**:
  - **A1 – Disillusioned Gen-Z/Millennials**: Feel left behind by current systems; low trust; low tolerance for walls of text; respond to agency, clarity, and emotional resonance.
  - **A2 – Collegiates / structurally-minded adults**: Cognitively see that the system is broken; want a serious, coherent alternative; respond to architecture, rigor, and mechanisms.
- **Success signals (v1)**:
  - From **Home**, a meaningful fraction of first-time visitors click **The Blueprint** or a "How it works" entry point.
  - On **Blueprint**, visitors interact with at least one node (hover/tap/click) and some continue into **The Tour** or a node's deeper content.
  - Qualitative tests: users in both A1 and A2 can answer, in their own words, "what this is" and "what problem it's trying to solve" after 1–2 minutes.

2. 2. Overall Information Architecture

- **Top-level nav direction** (from focus group consensus):
  - `Home` – emotional hook, problem framing.
  - `The Blueprint` – visual map: *"What is this system?"*
  - `The Tour` – guided, interactive journey: *"Show me and convince me"*.
  - `κ.τ.λ. (More)` – lore, Nyctimene, Owl, docs, etc.; deeper engagement.
- **Relationship between Blueprint and Tour**:
  - **Blueprint** shows structure and loops (hub + big balloons).
  - **Tour** shows *why users should care* via stories and interactive sequences (including Nyctimene as a guide after orientation).
  - Each Blueprint node should have a clear affordance to **"jump into the Tour"** at the relevant section.

3. 3. Content & Concept Design for Blueprint

- **3.1 Core visual model (v0/v1)**
  - **Center hub**: Pnyx/Ekklesia – "citizen assembly" as *visible core*.
  - **Four primary loops/"balloons"** around hub (v0 scope):
    - Aegis/Thérmansis → Ekklesia loop (protection & care).
    - Therapon/Dokimazo → Ekklesia loop (service & vetting).
    - GlaukÓS Mati/Logodosia → Ekklesia loop (watchdog & transparency).
    - Paideia/Generational Fairness/Jr. Ekklesia → Ekklesia loop (education & succession).
  - **Future stubs**: visually mark additional nodes (Hephaistia, Workshop Economy, Misthos, etc.) as "coming" without overloading v0.
- **3.2 Language strategy (Sonny + Neo + Lex)**
  - **English-first labels, Greek as secondary**:
    - Primary label: plain English (e.g., "Accountability Loop").
    - Secondary: Greek name as subtitle or tooltip (e.g., "Glaukós Mati / Logodosia").
  - Each node/balloon uses a **strict microcopy template**:
    - **1-line purpose** ("What this loop does for you").
    - **1-line painkiller** (Neo's "what changes in my life" – e.g., "Stops 51% whiplash" / "Prevents capture" / "Builds stable futures").
    - Optional: 2–3 bullets or a short paragraph in the deeper view.
- **3.3 Progressive disclosure**
  - First view: **only hub + four big loops**, minimal text, strong labels.
  - Hover/tap on a node: tooltip with the microcopy above.
  - Click: open a **detail panel or section** with:
    - Short narrative tying the loop to a real pain point for A1 and A2.
    - A simple mini-diagram or animation of the feedback loop.
    - A clear button: **"See this in The Tour"** (deep link).

4. 4. Interaction & UX Principles

- **4.1 Blueprint page behavior**
  - Works on both pointer and touch:
    - Hover → tooltip; tap on mobile → show tooltip; second tap → open detail.
  - The map is **never a dead-end**:

        - Global CTA in or near the map: "Start the Tour".
        - Per-node CTA: "See how this loop works" / "Jump into the Tour at this loop".
- **4.2 Avoiding pitfalls called out by the group**
    - **Pretty infographic that explains nothing** (Neo, Lex, Otto):
        - Every node must complete the sentence: **"This exists so that..."** in concrete, user-level terms.
        - No diagram element is purely decorative; each corresponds to a mechanism users will see in The Tour.
    - **Greek overload**:
        - Never require understanding a Greek term to grasp the map.
        - Greek appears as flavor and deep link to Glossary, not as a gate.
    - **Blueprint vs. marketing**:
        - Blueprint is factual and system-oriented; The Tour carries more narrative/emotional weight.
- **4.3 Integration with Glossary and other content**
    - From any node detail, Greek term or key concept text should be **clickable** to open:
        - Either a side panel with the Glossary entry, or
        - A new tab on Glossary pre-filtered to that entry.
    - Ensure users never have to leave Blueprint/Tour context completely just to look up a term.

5. 5. Nyctimene & κ.τ.λ. Placement

- **Nyctimene**:
    - Avoid using Nyctimene as a "lore gate" before people understand the basics (Neo, Otto, Lex).
    - Recommended flow:
        - Home may feature subtle owl imagery / small "Who is the Owl?" link.
        - **The Tour**: Nyctimene appears as a *guide* once the user grasps "what this is".
        - Full story and deeper lore live under κ.τ.λ. with cross-links from Tour.
- **κ.τ.λ. (More)**:
    - Keep it, but ensure affordances (chevron, hover state) make it obviously a dropdown.
    - Contents: Glossary, Nyctimene/Owl, white paper, dev notes, etc.

6. 6. Execution Phasing (Spec & Iteration)

6.1. 6.1 Phase 0 – Product spec & success metrics (your "spec" step)

- Write a short **Product Requirements Doc (PRD)** for Blueprint + Tour IA:
  - Problem statement (blank user, two target audiences).
  - Goals and non-goals.
  - Key user journeys:
    - Home → Blueprint → node → Tour.
    - Home → Tour (Nyctimene intro) → Blueprint.
  - Success metrics:
    - % of new visitors who visit Blueprint.
    - % who interact with ≥1 node.
    - % who proceed to Tour from Blueprint.
    - Qualitative comprehension from a small user test (can they retell what AreTéCracy is and name one loop?).
- This is essentially the modern version of the specs you remember: still very relevant, but shorter, outcome-focused, and built to support iterative releases.

6.2. 6.2 Phase 1 – Blueprint v0 (four loops, minimal detail)

- Implement a first version with:
  - Center hub + four major loops only.
  - Tooltips with 1–2 sentences each and simple CTAs.
  - A single "Start the Tour" button from the page.
- Use this to test:
  - Do users understand the hub-and-loops idea at all?
  - Which loops attract the most curiosity (for prioritizing deeper work)?

6.3. 6.3 Phase 2 – Deeper node details & Tour integration

- For each primary loop:
  - Create a consistent **detail pattern** (Lex's template):
    - Short purpose + painkiller summary.
    - Mini diagram / illustration of the loop.
    - 3–4 bullets on how it protects users or fixes a failure mode.
    - Button: "Enter the Tour here" → deep link into relevant Tour step.

- Ensure The Tour's structure can be deep-linked and can explain in narrative form *why* each loop matters.

6.4. 6.4 Phase 3 – Visual refinement & extended nodes

- Upgrade from playground visuals to **production design**:
  - Professional pass on the Blueprint art (avoid conspiracy-chart vibes; keep clean and modern).
  - Animations/transitions tuned to feel deliberate, not noisy.
- Add additional balloons/nodes (Hephaistia, Misthos, etc.) as the Tour and Glossary content for them is ready.

6.5. 6.5 Phase 4 – Measurement, A/B and iteration

- Instrument page with analytics:
  - Events: nav clicks, node hovers/clicks, Tour entry from each node, Glossary opens from Blueprint.
  - Funnel views: Home → Blueprint → Tour → downstream engagement (e.g., signups, JOIN US, time on site).
- Optionally A/B:
  - Copy on node summaries (e.g., more emotional vs. more technical lines).
  - Positioning/wording of CTAs ("Start the Tour" vs. "See how this works").
- Use data + 4–6 person qualitative interviews from both A1 and A2 to refine wording and layout.

7. 7. How This Relates to Modern Software Management

- **Your old process still maps well**: gather user needs → write spec with clear acceptance criteria → build → test against criteria.
- Modern best practice adds:
  - **Outcome-focused PRDs** instead of huge specs (what user problem, what success looks like, constraints).
  - **Iterative vertical slices**: ship Blueprint v0 with four loops first, then deepen; don't wait for the fully annotated system map.
  - **Instrumentation from day one**: define events/metrics in the spec and wire them when you build, so you can see if Blueprint actually improves engagement.

- **Design + copy as first-class citizens**: treat the microcopy templates and visual hierarchy as part of the spec, not afterthoughts.

In short: yes, your spec-and-milestones instinct is still right, but paired with staged releases (v0 → v1 → v2) and explicit engagement metrics, it will let the team move quickly while still being rigorous.